



Eyewear Mobile App

UX Design Case Study

This case study was created as part of a UX design portfolio to demonstrate the application of the Google UX Design Certificate Framework. The project uses LUNA, an eyewear boutique in Nepal, as the design context.

Project Overview

Luna is an eyewear boutique with no digital presence. Customers currently have no way to browse styles, explore prescription options, or book eye doctor appointments from their phones. They must visit the store or call during business hours.

The goal of this project is to design a mobile app that bridges that gap: giving customers a beautiful, functional digital experience that reflects LUNA's identity while solving real users' problems.

The UX design process

This document covers Step 1: Empathize. The goal of this phase is to deeply understand users, who they are, what they need, what frustrates them, and what motivates them.

Research Approach

For this project, I used the proto-persona approach. Proto personas are research informants, hypothetical users built when direct interview access is limited.

To build the proto-personas, I asked the following questions

Research Approach

- Who is most likely to use a local eyewear store's mobile app?
- What frustrations do they currently have with finding and buying eyewear?
- What does success look like for each type of user?
- How does their context (time, budget, lifestyle) shape their needs?

User Personas

I identified three different, distinct personas for the LUNA app, each with different goals, contexts, and pain points. Having multiple personas ensures the design serves a diverse set of real users.

Persona 1: Jenny Pradhan

The Fashion-conscious Professional

27 | Marketing Assistant | Kathmandu

Prescription glasses · Daily wearer · Style-driven

GOALS

- Find frames that match her aesthetic without spending hours in the store
- Feel confident about her frame choice before buying
- Keep her prescription up to date without it feeling like a chore

EMPATHY MAP

Says	Thinks
"I never know if frames will look good on me until I try them on."	What if I order online and the frames don't suit my face shape?
"I always end up going to the store just to check it wastes so much time."	I wish I could see how these look on someone like me before deciding.
"I want glasses that feel like part of my look, not just something functional."	My prescription is probably overdue. I should book an appointment soon.
"Booking an eye exam feels like such a hassle, I keep putting it off."	I don't really understand the difference between lens types.
Does	Feels
Browses Instagram and Pinterest for eyewear inspiration before shopping.	Frustrated when she can't visualize how frames look without going in person.
Visits the store in person just to try on frames, even without intending to buy.	Excited when she finds a frame style that matches her aesthetic perfectly.
Googles "glasses for oval face shape" before going to the store.	Overwhelmed by too many options with no guidance on what suits her.
Delays booking eye exams for months because the process feels complicated	Anxious about spending money on frames she might not love once she gets them.

PAINS

- Can't tell if frames suit her face before buying
- No easy way to browse styles on her phone
- Booking eye appointments is confusing and time-consuming
- Doesn't know when her prescription needs updating

GAINS

- Wants to feel confident that her choice suits her face
- Loves discovering new styles that match her personality
- Wants to book an eye exam to be as easy as booking a restaurant
- Wants one place to manage glasses, prescriptions, and appointments

HOW LUNA HELPS

Jenny opens the app on her lunch break, browses the catalogue filtered by face shape, saves three frames to her Wishlist, and books an eye exam for Saturday, all in under 5 minutes. When she walks into the store, she already knows exactly what she wants to try.

Persona 2: Samy Shrestha

The Busy Parent

41 | Operations Director | Father of 2 | Bhaktapur

Family Appointments · Time Poor · Practical Buyer

GOALS

- Book eye appointments for himself and two kids without back-and-forth calls
- Get reminders so appointments do not slip through the cracks
- Browse practical, durable frames for kids quickly and efficiently

EMPATHY MAP

Says	Thinks
"I keep meaning to book the kids' eye exams, but I never have time during the day."	I should have booked this months ago. What if my kids' vision is getting worse?
"By the time I remember to call the store, they're already closed."	Why can't I just do this from my phone at night like everything else?
"I just need something quick. I don't want to spend an hour picking frames."	I hope I can get all three of us in on the same day, so I only make one trip.
"My kids need durable frames, not fancy ones."	I don't want to forget again. I need a reminder system.
Does	Feels
Manages everything from his phone, banking, groceries, and school apps, all late at night.	Guilty for keeping his kids' eye appointments delayed. It's been over a year.
Writes "book eye doctor" on his to-do list repeatedly but never follows through.	Frustrated that basic health admin is so hard to fit around a busy schedule.
Misses the store's calling hours because he's in meetings all day.	Relieved when he gets things off his list, especially health-related tasks.
Tries to batch family errands into Saturday to minimize disruption to the week.	Overwhelmed by the idea of picking frames for himself and two kids in one visit.

PAINS

- Can only think about appointments late at night when the store is closed
- No way to book multiple family appointments in one session
- No reminders, relies on memory, which always fails
- Dreads spending a long time in-store browsing frames. Doesn't know when his prescription needs updating

GAINS

- Wants to handle it all in one place, in under 10 minutes
- Needs automatic reminders he can rely on
- Wants to pre-select frames before arriving, so store visits are fast
- Feels good when family health is organized and up to date

HOW LUNA HELPS

Suman books three appointments at 10 pm from his couch, one for himself and one for each child, choosing back-to-back slots on a Saturday. He receives a confirmation and a 24-hour reminder. He also filters the catalogue by durable kids frames and shortlists two options before setting foot in the store.

Persona 3: Abhi Shakya

The Style Seeker

23 | Graphic Design Student | Lalitpur

Sunglasses · Budget-Conscious · Trend Aware

GOALS

- Find designer-inspired sunglasses that look elevated but are affordable
- Discover new styles that match current trends he follows on social media
- Feel like he is getting great quality and value, not a cheap copy

EMPATHY MAP

Says	Thinks
"I love the look of Vogue and Tom Hardy, but I can't afford them, like, not even close."	If I can't afford the real thing, I'd rather save up than buy something that looks bad.
"Most affordable sunglasses just look cheap. I'd rather have nothing."	I wonder if anyone would notice these aren't designer, or would they just look good?
"I want something that looks intentional, not like I just grabbed whatever was on sale."	I follow all these trends, but I can never actually participate in them.
"I didn't even know local stores had options like this."	There must be a smarter way to look put-together without spending a fortune.
Does	Feels
Spends time on Instagram and Pinterest saving eyewear styles he aspires to own.	Excluded from fashion trends he loves because they're financially out of reach.
Searches "affordable designer dupe sunglasses" regularly, but results feel low-quality.	Self-conscious about buying cheap-looking accessories that undermine his whole look.
Browses fast fashion accessory sections but rarely finds anything that feels elevated.	Excited when he finds something that doesn't break his student budget.
Studies what makes designer frames look expensive, shape, material, and finish.	Proud when his style choices get noticed, he wants to be seen as intentional.

PAINS

- Designer styles he loves are completely unaffordable on a student budget
- Affordable alternatives feel cheap and undermine his aesthetic
- Doesn't know local stores like LUNA carry elevated options
- Feels left out of trends he closely follows online

GAINS

- Wants elevated style at a price that doesn't cause stress
- Needs to feel proud of his purchase, not like he's settling
- Loves discovering new styles before peers do
- Wants to look intentional and put-together on a budget

HOW LUNA HELPS

Abhi finds LUNA's designer-inspired collection in the app. He filters by style, oversized, tortoise shell, cat-eye, and finds a pair that mirrors the frames he saved on Pinterest at a fraction of the price. The product page shows the design inspiration clearly, so he feels he is making a stylish, informed choice.